Frida Sofía López Bravo

Harvard University

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Education

2023 – 2027 (expected) **Harvard University**
A.B. in Government and Mathematics

2019 – 2023 **Lycée Franco-Mexicain**, Mexico City
French Baccalauréat (Mathematics and Engineering Sciences) and Mexican diploma
Full scholarship from the French and Mexican governments; top 10, French Mathematics Olympiad

Research Interests

Field	Comparative politics, with a regional focus on Latin America
Topics	The politics of counting and information institutions; state building and weak institutions; forbearance; crimes committed by the state
Methods	Quantitative and mixed methods

Senior Thesis

2026 – 2027 "To Disappear Twice: Politics of Counting Around Forced Disappearances in Mexico."
Advisor: Yanilda González

I explain why Mexico's national registry of the disappearances remains unreliable despite a legal mandate and sustained domestic and international pressure. I argue that registry opacity is politically produced: where accurate data would expose state failure, officials sustain *managed legibility* through politically mediated capacity constraints, strategic non-enforcement, and administrative blockage.

Data and methods: original panel of weekly registry scrapes, freedom-of-information requests, and elite and civil society interviews.

Research Experience

2026 – present **Research Assistant to Professor Yanilda González**, Harvard University
Data analysis for a project on police violence in Latin America.

Summer 2026 **Data Analysis and Research Intern**, Save the Children, New York
Harmonized and analyzed cross-country education data in R and Python to maintain and expand Save the Children's IDELA database.

Fall 2025 **Research Assistant to Professor Alisha Holland**, Harvard University
Data collection and comparative research on populist bureaucratic reform in the United States and Argentina.

2025 – present **Data Analyst and Researcher**, Data Cívica, Mexico City
Intern, summer 2025; volunteer, 2025 – present
Develop statistical and research tools for projects on forced disappearances and femicide in Mexico.

2024 – 2025 **Radcliffe Research Partner to Professor Paulo Fontes**, Radcliffe Institute for Advanced Study
Archival research on labor unions and racial democracy in Brazil.

Grants, Fellowships, and Awards

2026 Summer Research Travel Grant, David Rockefeller Center for Latin American Studies

2026 Summer Research Funding, Harvard College Research Program

2026 Saloma Fund Thesis Research Grant, Department of Government (declined)

2026 Moral Ambition University Fellowship, one of 12 Harvard juniors selected

2025 Summer Service Stipend, Institute of Politics

Teaching

Fall 2026 **Course Assistant**, Gov 50: Data Science for the Social Sciences, Harvard University

Fall 2026 **Course Assistant**, Phil 4: Logic I, Harvard University

Service

2024 – present **Co-President**, Harvard Association Cultivating Inter-American Democracy (HACIA)
Annual democracy conference for 350+ high school students from across Latin America.

Skills

Languages Spanish, English, French, and Portuguese (all fluent)

Programming R, Python, LaTeX

Methods Causal inference, statistical modeling, web scraping and API data collection, archival research, semi-structured interviews